minjokherald

December 20th, 2012 | Volume 27. No.1 47th edition | Publisher Yun Chung-Il (headmaster)

Editor's Note

'Tis the season.
With the holidays fast approaching,
new energies and cheer seem to fill the air
as everyone seems to have one reason or the other to be in high spirits.
It feels as if those days of struggling
with that next US History quiz or a paper for Mr. Ganse are long gone.
Yet, it's not this hiatus from our hectic lives that makes the holidays.
It' not even the catchy carols or thematic decorations.
It's the companionship, friendliness, and engagement
with the people so important in our lives.
The teachers who have taught us so diligently during the past semester,
the friends we've made so many invaluable memories with,
the loving family members who gave their unremitting support.
In regard to the holiday spirit,
I would like to extend my gratitude to all those
who contributed in making this issue of *Minjok Herald* possible.
All the staff members and their efforts put into this issue,
the people who selflessly gave up their time to be interviewed,
those who gave constructive criticism for our betterment,
and those who were kind enough to slip in a kind word of encouragement.
When looking around, there is much to be thankful for,
and perhaps you will find the same sort of thing in this issue.
The events and people that made our semester
so precious and meaningful and something to be thankful for.

Most Sincerely,
Editor-in-Chief
Lee Eun-Ji

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BY THE STUDENTS and
FOR THE STUDENTS

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Ticket Sales Neither Forced nor for Fundraising

Headmaster Talks Minjok Music Festival

On the 17th of November 2012, various genres of music such as hip-hop, rock, ballad, and traditional Korean music filled the walls of Sangmyung Arts Hall as the annual Minjok Music Festival was held. All KMLAian performers had practiced diligently for this performance, and indeed parents and teachers seemed to have enjoyed the much-prepared show. However, there was an issue behind this performance that brought up various opinions between students - the issue of ticket sales for Minjok Music Festival.

Ever since the start of November, rumors about the school forcing parents to buy a certain number of tickets for the Minjok Music Festival swept the school, especially among the 17th wavers. Small talk between students and numerous facebook postings revealed the complaints and dissatisfactions that students harbored. Due to the fundraising purposes of the festival last year, a majority of students continue to view the festival as a forced fundraiser. "The headmaster keeps on associating money with the Minjok Music Festival. It's obvious that there are economic purposes behind the flowery 'artistic experience' explanation he gives," says one 16th waver. Even a KMLA parent of a 17th waver commented, "We have no problem contributing to the well-being of the school. However, the school needs to explicitly state where the money from the music festival will be spent on."

The school, however, shed new light onto the issue. Dr. Yun Chung-Il, the headmaster of KMLA, strongly emphasized in an interview with Minjok Herald, that the school never forced any parent to pay a certain amount of money for the Minjok Music Festival. "The school never had any intentions of earning money from anyone and wanted parents to feel free and relaxed about coming to the music festival," says Dr. Yun. When asked about the fundraising purposes of the festival Dr. Yoon answered that the fundraising aspect of the festival for the girls' dormitory was limited to last year. "The money from ticket sales goes to the budget for borrowing space for the concert and such. Last year, it took about 35,000,000 won, which means that about the same amount of money is needed for this year as well," he says. "If money is left over from hosting the music festival, it is used for improving school facilities and such."

Perhaps due to this interview, Dr. Yun Chung-Il reiterated in the next morning assembly (November 26th) the purpose of the music festival to the students. He especially emphasized to them, "do not misunderstand." Yet, the cause of misunderstanding seems to be miscommunication. To prevent such miscommunication, a clear and precise method of conveyance and efforts of both sides to understand is needed.

Kim, Byeong-Yun
Junior Writer, 17th Wave

Students Want More Say in Producing Music Festival

But School and Students Harbor Different Viewpoints

In enumerating some important school events of the second semester, Minjok Music Festival cannot be excluded. The concert is a grand event started last year that is open not only current students and teachers, but parents, preliminary freshmen, and even graduates. Performing in such a big stage definitely is considered a grateful chance that other high school students can hardly experience.

However, this year, 17th waver Sung Si-Yun proposed that students be given a chance to produce the Minjok Music Festival, the reason being that although the students are the main participants of the festival, they have little say in the production of it (including auditions, order of performances, limits on performance time). It was proposed that if the students created a group for producing the festival or if student opinions were reflected under the supervision of the student council, the students would have a more enjoyable and meaningful festival. When this issue was discussed in KMLA Forum, most of the students agreed that the school should grant students more control over the concert preparation. 16th waver Kim Seung-Jun commented, "Considering that the concert is an 'official' ceremony, vesting students with full rights would be unfeasible. However, granting autonomy to some extent – organizing program schedules or arranging performing time, for example – would be desirable."

However, Mrs. In Su-Yeon, the main promoter of the concert, explained that she in fact does try to reflect students' opinions when designing the program. Last year, for example, she asked the 11th Executive Council to submit the list of 'possible programs.' Those included official performing clubs such as Minjok Orchestra, KMLA Orchestra Samuchim, and unofficial performing club members who wished to perform. Mrs. In believed that such process allows students to perform what they would like to do. She admitted that this year's program was planned based on that of last year, rather than a new survey. But she expressed her consideration on offering students wider chance to participate in next year's concert; for example, giving the Executive Council chance to plan the entire programs.

According to the 11th Executive Council, however, it is true that the Council submitted the list of clubs and non-clubs which hope to perform, but other programs, such as choir, were planned by the school. Because of this, students who were not included in the list – ones who did not belong to any performing official/unofficial clubs – had to join these school-arranged programs against their will.

The school claims that it tries to communicate with students and reflect their opinions, and to some extent, students do have a say. Nevertheless, the communication is not yet fully operating. Therefore, a higher degree of student autonomy via more active exchange of opinions between school and the students is expected in next year's concert.

Park Ye-Ji
Staff Writer, 16th Wave

Number One School, Number One Concern

School Eager to Act upon Satisfaction Survey Results in Improving Class Curriculum

As the school ambience is lifted up in anticipation of greeting the newly registered 18th wave, many Korean Minjok Leadership Academy (KMLA) students think back to their first expectations of school. Many feel a tinge of disappointment and doubt on whether KMLA is really the dream school they looked up to. However, the result of a recent survey of satisfaction conducted by Korean Educational Development Institute (KEDI) discloses a different perspective. Held in June, the survey was filled out by KMLA teachers, students, and parents from two 10th grade classes and two 11th grade classes. The result was astonishing; KMLA marked above average in every item. KMLA ranked highest among all the special-purpose high schools in Korea.

Nevertheless, some items, though higher than the average scores of other high schools, were considered to have scored low in the standard of KMLA. Among these items, the head of the Division of Academic Affairs, Mr. Park Hyeong-Jong emphasized one item: 'The classes are divided and efficiently operated into different levels in accordance with student's ability.' Disappointed at the score of 3.78 out of 5, he suggested some hindrances in and possible solutions to opening a leveled class or supplement class which is the supreme concern for next term.

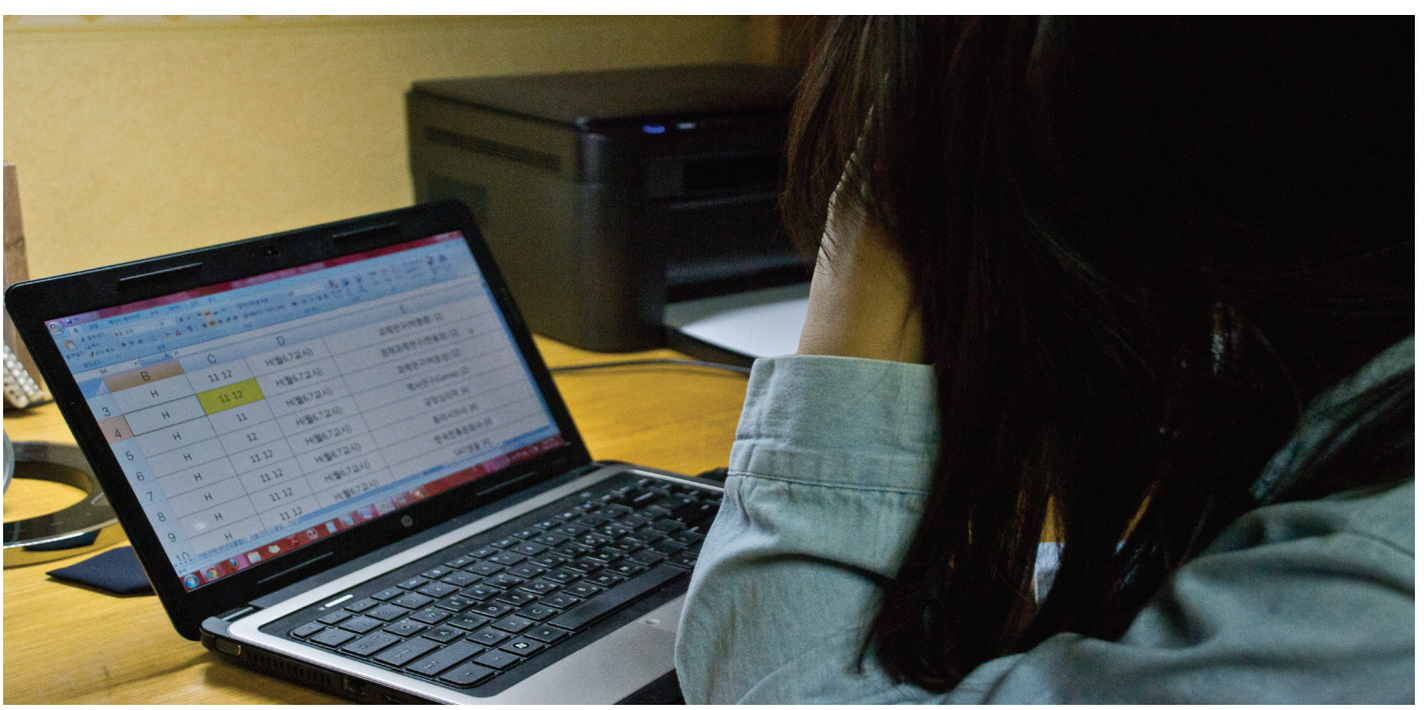
"Primarily, many students do not intensely request these supplementary classes," says Mr. Park, an opinion similar to that of Mr. Park Yong-Sung, another teacher working at the Division of Academic Affair. He expressed the dilemma, "When one student appeals an idea, teachers in academic affairs section can never be sure whether the idea suggested belongs to the majority or the minority."

In an attempt to change these paradigms, Mr. Park Hyeong-Jong stressed students' active and strong requests to the school. He said this will build powerful ground for teachers involved in academic affairs in establishing supplementary classes. On the other hand, Mr. Park Yong-Sung pointed out, "The student council should play an active role in collecting and proposing student's opinions and in delivering them to the teachers." In response, the chief of the Executive Council, Lee Chung-Hyun mentioned, "The student council's process of specifying and mustering students' opinions will be more efficient after the general and systemic school-wide systemic survey."

Moreover, as both the teacher and students do not have much free time during the day, Mr. Park Hyeong-Jong says. "Night class is also difficult because students have too much homework and quizzes to take extra classes. Placing 4 units of supplementary classes out of 16 units of the self-regulated selection module (H, I, J, K, L, M, N, O) may solve this problem," Mr. Park Hyeong-Jong says.

Like this, this survey is bringing about new matters and perspectives to the school education system. Teachers in the Office of Curricular Management have already increased self-regulated selection module from four units to twelve units, reinforcing our school's merits, diversified classes. Further taking into account the result, the teachers are going to design the classes until next May. In this process numerous teachers look for students' active participation and feedbacks to reflect students' opinion for KMLA's education system. There is hardly a doubt that this enhanced communication will further increase student satisfaction.

Jeon So-Yeon
Staff Writer, 16th wave



Entrance Interview, its System and Policies Still Reaching Maturity

Male applicants during the 17th wave entrance interview, waiting for the physical examination of the four kilometer run

"I'm so nervous." "That's all right. You can do it." If one were to enter Dasan building in Korean Minjok Leadership Academy (KMLA) during the period of the interviews, one would easily hear this kind of conversation between the applicant and the Program Assistant (PA). From October 25th to 28th, the entrance interview was held in KMLA. The applicants had to go through three stages for KMLA admissions: the middle school student report evaluation, the letter of introduction evaluation that is based on the KMLA format, and the entrance interview. Among the three stages, the final interviewing process is known to be an important factor in whether applicants are selected or not.

It has already been three years since KMLA began to conduct the interview process as an entrance exam. Due to the changed education policy, teachers were not able to evaluate applicants based on academic awards or standardized test scores such as TOEFL scores. Thus, the interview system was introduced as a replacement of the evaluation system based on external activities (awards, test scores) and the exam called the 'Gifted Selection Examination.' "We are trying our best to discern the qualified student for KMLA through the interviewing process, though the pool of applicants became narrower than before [due to the new educational policy requiring students to apply to only one special-purpose high school]," the Manager of the Admission Office says.

As such, KMLA is striving to build a solid and stable foundation for the interview system and the interview-related policies in order to select the right students for KMLA. After the 18th wave students enter the school, all three grades will be filled up with students who were selected through process of the entrance interview. The application of the new entrance system caused both anticipation and apprehension among the school. However, regardless of changed admission process and policy, both 16th and 17th wavers seem to be living up to KMLA's expectations and KMLA teachers continue to show their passion to select students most suited for KMLA.

Kim Ri-Hyun
Junior Writer, 17th Wave

KMLA Clubs Take Victory!

Students Display Passion for Club Activities Despite Busy Schedules

It is hard for students of Korean Minjok Leadership Academy (KMLA) to stay passionate about extracurricular (EC) activities, when they are constantly swirled in the tempest of assignments, essays, and presentations. Various EC clubs exist but many students feel that it is hard to keep up with all their activities. "When we are freshmen we're excited about everything," says a student, who chose to remain anonymous, "so we join more clubs than we can manage, and after just one semester we all realize, that we're not supermen, but just ordinary students who must bust themselves to shove into university admission, instead of being excited about EC's."

It is true that reality doesn't entirely approve of active participation in EC's. However, that does not mean students have to lose passion in them. Recently, two EC clubs have shown that passion for EC's does have a place in reality. The clubs of Crossover and KANDLES have gained recognition through passion and devotion.

Crossover captain Hwang In-Chan says, "Please don't think of feeble, hard-headed nerds when you think of KMLA." He's not being arrogant here, for Crossover proved the strength of KMLA when they took the 3rd place in Gangwon School Sports Club Competition (GSSCC). The competition was held from September 22nd to 23rd.

Compared to the Gangwon Sports Competition, GSSCC is less known to KMLAians, but for Crossover, GSSCC meant a lot, since each year there are more high school teams competing at GSSCC than the Gangwon Sports Competition. "It's a big-time event," says Koo Han-Gyeol, a Crossover member, "and we wouldn't have gotten anywhere without rigorous practices, and help from Mr. Kim Myung-Soon and Mr. Kim Hun-Min." Mr. Kim Hun-Min is a professional basketball coach, who has been coacheing Crossover since the 12th wave.

KMLA varsity cheer team,KANDLES

"Admittedly," says You Jun-Seung, a member also, "KMLAians on the average have inferior physique and less time to contribute to sports." "But still it's possible," he continues, "to be playing basketball while you study hard at the same time. You just have to be a little stricter with yourself." When questioned about what it is that keeps them so self-controlled, Crossover members all agreed that it was their passion that kept them in place.

KANDLES achieved a huge feat also. It took home the gold medal in the 2012 Korean Varsity Cheerleading Competition. This competition is quite a serious one, as it is not supposed to be for amateur hobbyists. It is, believe it or not, where professional cheerleading athlete-artists compete for their ticket to the world competition. It was KANDLES who took this ticket, along with a 500,000 won worth of prizes.

KANDLES is an already well-known club among KMLA students for its extra hard practices. They have unusually long practice hours, and the intensity is as great as, if not more, that of other EC clubs. Every Wednesday KANDLES members march to the 3rd floor of Chung-Moo Building during their precious 1st self-study period and also get together on Sports Days. When there is a competition, three self-study periods are sacrificed every week. "Frankly speaking, sometimes it gets really frustrating," confesses Lee Ho-Wook, a KANDLES member, "when there is a big quiz on Thursday and they still don't see it as an excuse." "But it's fine really," he explains, "because I joined this club fully aware of the hard schedule. I agreed to the terms, so I'm supposed to keep up." Such passion of KANDLES is led by Ms. Jung Mi-Ra and a professional coach.

Members of Crossover and KANDLES have shown that it is possible to cope with busy schedules and participate in EC's at the same time. How they defied the power of reality that puts us under so much pressure is amazing. "But it's possible for anyone," says Koo Han-Gyeol, "if he or she would just realize it's possible." "It's possible," says Lee Ho-Wook, "because this is KMLA and nowhere else." As our headmaster once said, "KMLA is KMLA because students know how to do things other than just sitting and studying."

KMLA boy basketball club, Crossover

Lee Eun-Do
Staff Writer, 16th Wave

Campus Couple Heyday Coming to a Close as Students and School Express Dissatisfaction

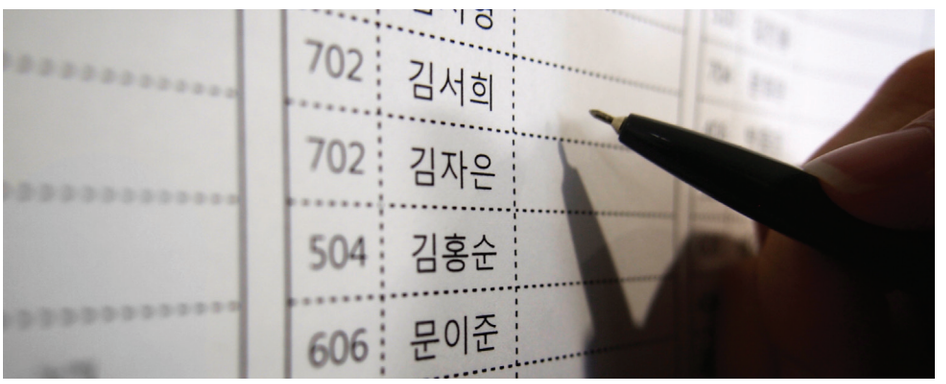
"Oh no, they are there again, every day!" A shout like this, full of annoyance and perhaps a bit of jealousy, could be heard in the cafeteria after honjeong during last few months. The reason lies in the surge of the number of cases of on-campus dating. There was said to be more than a dozen pairs of couples in the 16th wave alone, and it is reported that it is the first time the school had to deal with so many couples in one wave. Though individual opinions may vary, it is of majority opinion that campus couples should be regulated to some extent.

The formation of couples cannot be perfectly prevented in Korean Minjok Leadership Academy (KMLA). "It's like putting salt and water in a cup and telling the salt not to melt," says one 16th waver. In such an environment where students interact with each other every day, it is almost inevitable that couples are formed every now and then, wanting to meet face-to-face. The other students tend to give some respect to the pair, avoiding or giving some space when couples meet. However, as much as students try to ignore the couples around them, it is a general opinion that it is impossible to not to pay any attention when couples are around students. "There are so many couples, it getting just more than annoying. "It feels like couples have taken over the cafeteria," says one (single) 16th wave student, implying that consideration which normal students are giving to couples is growing thin.

Students aren't the only ones who are not content about the situation regarding couples. The school, especially the Division of Student Affairs, is more than 'dissatisfied' with the number of couples existing in the campus. Mr. Kim Myeong-Soon, the head of the Division of Student said, "This is a matter of existence of the school. It is as serious as that. The school does not allow any deeper relationship than close friends between opposite genders." As if to prove his comment, the school is taking extensive measures to regulate on-campus dating. They have already formulated a list of names of couples which was sent to all the teachers in the Division of Student Affairs and held a meeting between the existing couples. Even a regulation regarding cafeteria use was made due to the frequent meetings of couples in the cafeteria. Considering the fact that KMLA is a dormitory school and parents are indeed very sensitive about the issue, the school takes on-campus dating very seriously.

"Why won't they just allow us to meet? It's so cruel to restrict couples when they like each other so much," commented one student. Yes, it is true that formation of couples is natural. Yes, the school may sound out-of-date and conservative. However, with the frowning of both students and teachers, happy days for couples seem to be over.

You Jun-Seung
Staff Writer, 16th Wave



As Policies Regulating Student Life Boom, So do Criticisms

A recent boom in policy creation has triggered much debate regarding their legitimacy. The following are the four new policies in question. First, students must stand up after the morning assembly until all of the teachers have left the gym. Second, due to the increased number of couples using the cafeteria as a meeting space, the dormitory parent announced that students must get permission before using the cafeteria during the second self-study period. Third, headmaster Yoon Jung-Il stated during the morning assembly that students cannot wear the mandated school uniform jacket, nubi, with informal clothing during morning exercise in order for students to "exercise properly." with informal clothing. Lastly, in order to prevent students from staying in their rooms because their 5th and 6th periods are empty, students without classes in the 5th and 6th periods must sign on a signing sheet before leaving the dormitory.

The reasons behind some of these policies are deemed just, such as the increased number of couples meeting in the cafeteria and the 13 students caught on September 27th sleeping in their dormitory rooms. So indeed, some KMLAians have accepting attitudes towards the policies. Some do agree that it is more polite to remain standing until the teachers leave the gym and that the cafeteria did become quieter and couples are no longer able to meet each other there. However, many seem to be skeptical of the newly enforced policies, as they believe that most are pointless, have too many side effects, or are partially unjust for well-behaving students.

As for the policy regarding getting permission to use the cafeteria, many expressed the inconvenience they faced. "This does not mean that couples will break up. This merely causes inconvenience for people with group projects," 17th waver Chae Yeon-Jung says. The policy prohibiting the wearing of the nubi was also met with confusion. Students did not fully comprehend the reason why such a policy was enforced. "The headmaster is imposing too much meaning on a piece of fabric," says 17th waver Son Yong-Seok.

The final policy was mainly criticized for its side effects and ineffectiveness. "It is the floor manager's responsibility to check the people in the room," 17th waver Kim Do-Hyung says about why the policy was unnecessary. "Most of them have classes in the 7th and 8th periods anyway" says 17th waver Chae Joo-Yeon. 17th waver Song Yong-Jin even suggested an alternative, stating "It'd be better to be checked by advisors."

Despite such responses from KMLAians, the policies are unlikely to do through any significant change. The school authorities seem to have obstinate views regarding the first and third policies. However, the last policy concerning the sigining sheet seems to be headed for change after the Student Council consulted Mr. Kim Myung-Soon, the Director of the Division of Student Affairs. He saw the letigimacy in limiting its enforcement to Thursdays.

For now, it seems that the policies will rem ain as they are, as their makers are unwilling to negotiate a compromise. Students continue to express their doubts on the legitimacy of the policies. However, if KMLA is to live up to its reputation as a "self-governing student republic," interchange between the teachers and KMLAians seems necessary.

Lee Jin-Kyu
Junior Writer, 17th Wave

Special Draft Committee meeting in the cafeteria

Special Draft Committee Launched Again

Enough Participants but Not Enough Time

On September 29th, the 14th Legislative Council made an ambitious announcement on KMLA Online. It was about one of the commitments that the elected candidates of the council had made during their campaign; the Special Draft Committee. It is not the first time for the Legislative Council to carry out the Special Draft Committee program. In fact, the 12th Legislative Council has also made attempts to activate this organization. However, the plan has been suspended during the 13th Legislative Council; and now it's back.

The Special Draft Committee is an autonomous league of students who are willing to engage themselves in amending the school 'student provisions.' Any students of all three grades can volunteer to be a member of the committee. Their term of office is one semester, the second semester of 2012. The members will be required to bring up doubts or objections toward every possible aspect of the provisions, from style and grammar to specific contexts. The Special Draft Committee that operated during the 12th Legislative Council actually accomplished in issuing a reform bill, which took effect from this year April 25th.

Owing to the passionate participation of the students, the Special Draft Committee has been put into action and is presently known to be making progress in the amendment process. On surface, the committee seems to be operating without problem, but this would not have been possible without the efforts of the members of the Legislative Council. Minjok Herald looked into the obstacles that the newborn committee faces.

Of the many deterrents, time has been ranked as the most problematic one. Lee Ha-Jung, president of the Legislative Council, says "The participation part, unlike our worries, was not a problem at all since many students were willing and enthusiastic to take part in the committee. However, drawing out the schedule that everyone could agree on and arranging the students on the right place was tough since many already had tight schedule and not everyone were well aware of the rules. Moreover, the general process of amending the rules takes time, so we are trying to minimize the procedural periods." The vice president Lee Jun-Suk also agrees with Ha-Jung's concerns, stating that "The second semester is full of school events and assignments that we have to cramp in the schedule for Special Draft Committee. I thank everyone who volunteered to participate in the committee." Since the Special Draft Committee is one of the key promises that the current Legislative Council made, time sure is a troublesome issue for them to take care of. Here a question rises; why go through all the trouble?

Traditionally, amendments of clauses or proposals of complaints on the rules have been the responsibility and main duties of the Legislative Council itself. An affiliated organization which separately discusses such works is a fairly new concept. Therefore, many have questioned the necessity of the committee as a supplementation of the legislation council. When asked this question, Ha-Jung answered, "It would be an abuse of legislative power to amend the rules by ourselves, since it is crucial to include as much student opinion as possible in the process. Thus, we have called the Special Draft Committee to lay proper grounds for reform and to receive diverse suggestions."

The Special Draft Committee, as the members of the Legislative Council admits, still has problems to solve and difficulties to overcome. They could have taken the easy path of discussing and deliberating the clauses by themselves and issuing the amendments, as most of the prior councils have done. However, wider opportunities for student participation were what they valued more than better convenience, and so the committee is on air once again. The entire school's attention is now centered on how this committee will turn out and whether the system will continue on to the next councils or not.

Lee Hye-Joon
Staff Writer, 16th Wave

November, the Month of Assignment Overload

Congratulations, KMLA! You Finally Made It!

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SUN / 일	MON / 월	TUE / 화	WED / 수	THU / 목	FRI / 금	SAT / 토
				1 APUSH Quiz AP World History Quiz	2	3 9.20 SAT
4	5 Calculus AB Quiz AP Bio Quiz	6 French Quiz	7 입동	8 APUSH Quiz Korean Book Quiz AP World History Quiz KSAT	9 소방의 날 Korean Government Theory Paper	10 휴토
11	12 AP Lang Essay AP Bio Quiz	13 Korean History Test (16th,17th) French Quiz	14 10.1 KSAT Mock Test	15 Mr.Ji paper Mr.Tweedie writing assign. Bio-Science2 Quiz AP World History Quiz	16 Rehearsal	17 Minjok Music Festival
18	19 Calculus Quiz AP Bio Quiz	20 17th Math Quiz AP Stat Assign. French Quiz	21 Korean Traditional Culture Quiz Am-Lit Presentation AP Physics Quiz	22 소설 APUSH Quiz Calculus BC Quiz AP World History Quiz	17th Math Quiz 23 10.10 Mr. Park Korean Fiction Mr. Park Korean Movie Paper Spanish Play Mr. Jeong Korean History Report	24 휴토
25	26 History of East Asia Quiz French Play Calculus Quiz Korean Paper 16th Math Quiz	27 French Quiz Ganse Paper Calculus BC take home assignment	28 Mr. Tweedie Writing Assign. Am-Lit Essay Ganse Paper Ms. Kang's In Class Essay	29 AP World History Quiz APUSH Quiz	30 Mr. Moon's Term Paper Bio-Science2 Quiz AP US Politics Paper Korean History UCC	

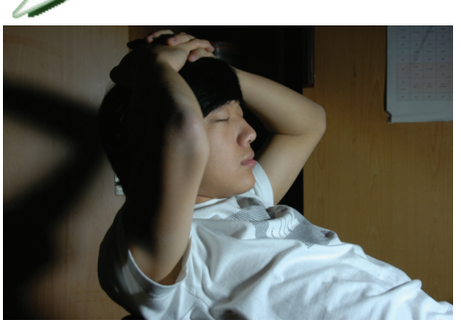
How to Deal with Menboongs

"I went to the Spainish Restaurant Tour during the weekend as a Creative Experience Activity. We need some deviation from studying all day."

16th waver Park Gyu-Yeon

"There's nothing like sleep when you're stressed out (laugh). At least for that brief period of sleep, the burden of assignment is forgotten."

16th waver Yoo Jun-Seung

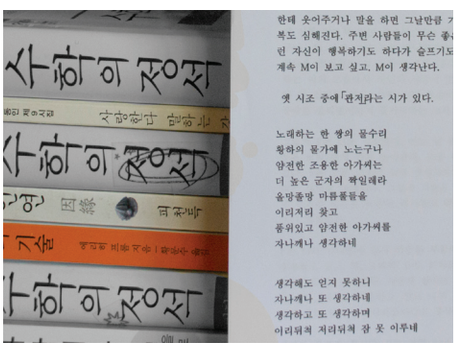


"It's really nice to know that there's someone out there cheering you on. A little note or tidbits of food are small joys in the tough high-school life."

16th waver Lee Chung-Hyun

"Knowledge is Not Something Conveyed, but Constructed"

Teachers Foster Student-Centered Learning through Creative Teaching Methods



Korea is known for its cramming method of education. Students are taught to memorize for tests, but later all the knowledge crammed in their heads are lost. However, teachers in Korean Minjok Leadership Academy (KMLA) are increasingly utilizing creative ways to foster student-centered learning in their lectures. Some of the representative pioneers of this change in teaching methods are Ms. Lee Won-Ki, Ms. Ji Hye-In, and Mr. Han Man-Wi.

$E=mc^2$: This is the cooking of mom. When you dive your spoon into the bowl and scoop up the soup, you are raising mass, and when it gets into your body, the mass changes into energy. Cooking of mom therefore changes mass into energy; love in mom's soup makes it possible.

Such touching metaphor is not from a poem: it is from one student's literature report for Ms. Lee Wonki's Korean class. What Ms. Lee instructed for the assignment was very simple: write about mother and literature. This made one student to create such beautiful metaphor, and create her own world from the cooking of her mother.

Ms. Lee had assigned several other reports with similar instructions: for example, write about love and literature. Such simple instructions made the student search diversely and think deeply about the topic, in various aspects. "Writing these reports allow me to have a novel view on things around me," said the student who created the metaphor.

Similar things happen in Ms. Ji Hye-In's class. Ms. Ji's class is usually held through the following process: quiz, student presentation with discussion, activities, and essay. "Activities done in her class are really interesting," says 16th waver Lee Ji-Eun, "and at the same time, they really help me understand the complicated philosophic idea."

At the end of the class, Ms. Ji assigns an essay due that midnight, its topic is usually being the criticism of two different pieces of writing. "I found the essay assignment very helpful," another 16th waver Kang Ji-Young remarks. "It's because the topic is somehow connected to the idea discussed in class but not explicitly; I need to think about the idea profoundly in order to find, or to create the connection. After all that, I can find myself with my own opinion on the philosophic idea; that's way more than just reading the textbook. I can explain to my friends what the idea is, and moreover, what I think about it."

"It's because knowledge is not something conveyed, but constructed." Ms. Ji said for the reason of her such ways of teaching. "Just conveying facts is not what a book should do, not a teacher. A teacher should help the students construct their own world."

Teaching methods to help students "construct their own world" is not limited to the young and new teachers like Ms. Lee and Ms. Ji. Mr. Han Man-Wi's Biology quiz was also reported to foster comprehension. Although the word quiz may connotate a cramming method of teaching, the questions of Mr. Han's quizzes require students not only to memorize the fact itself but also to grasp the main point of it and to convey it.

16th waver Yoon Se-Eun reported that she really feels like studying when she studies for Mr. Han's Biology quiz. "Nobody can get the question right if he just memorizes, or understands superficially on the text. Students really need to know the core in order to get good scores," she says. Another 16th waver Moon Hee-Eun, agreed, "His quiz does indeed make me study hard."

In KMLA, there are teachers who teach students how to be the blacksmith of their fields: they enable students to get to really 'know' what they are studying, and they can do it because they know that knowledge is something 'constructed' not 'conveyed.' Teachers help students to create their own world with their own thoughts. Being able to explain the warmth of mom's soup with a formula, students of KMLA create a world of their self-earned knowledge.

Ms. Ji teaching her ethics class

Kim Sol
Staff Writer, 16th Wave

Dramatic Decrease in the Number of International Fields Students

Financial Burden and Risk-Taking Main Reasons for Decrease

"Hey, don't you know? He's coming to domestic field! I thought everybody knew that." As the semester nears end and students start to make plans for next semester, the news of handful of students switching fields can be heard over the campus. As most of the KMLA students might have noticed, majority of the students who switch fields come from international to domestic, drastically increasing the domestic field students for last few years. According to the statistics, the ratio of domestic field-students and international field-students is nearly 2-to-1, meaning two out of three people are domestic. Though individual reasons exist, the major factors of field migration can be seen.

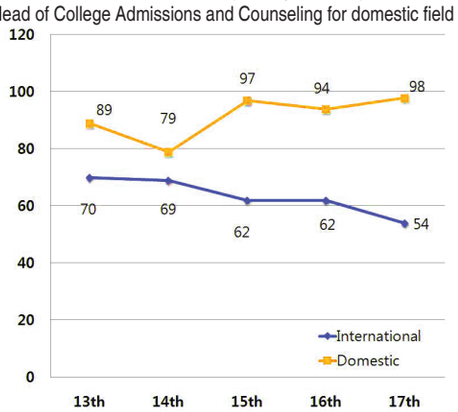
According to a survey done by Minjok Herald, students' opinion of the most dominant reason of changing fields was the economic one. Some might think that students whose families are able to afford for KMLA have enough money to pay for studying abroad. However, that's a big mistake: the amount of investment needed for a student to study abroad is astronomical. It is said that roughly 50 million won is needed per year to guarantee a stable life in American universities. Such amount of money is a devastating load for many families. It is a public opinion that studying abroad risks too many things for a small chance of success in foreign country. "It's just that, I'm not, or my family's not willing to take that much risk and investment for such a small chance of success. We can't just keep on pursuing our dreams, but have to face the reality too", says one 16th wave student, who switched fields to domestic last semester. On the opposite of international field, domestic field have much higher chance of securing a stable position in the Korean society, since many students in KMLA are enter top universities in Korea, such as Seoul National University. "To put in a nutshell, international field is way too expensive and domestic field guarantees a much more stable position in the society", commented an international field student who grieve the decrease in number of students in international field.

Teacher's opinion was bit different from the one of students. According to Mr. Kang Mun-Geun, the Head of College Admissions and Counseling for the domestic field, says this phenomenon isn't a problem but just a part of the trend cycle. Meaning that domestic field is popular for few years that the international filed is popular for few years and then domestic field is popular, and so on. He gave an example of 1st and 2nd wave that domestic students were domestic at that time and in 7th wave most of the students wanted to study abroad. He also said, "Furthermore, my personal opinion is that students nowadays think it's easy to go to top universities such as SNU when you are a domestic student in KMLA. However, that is wrong. It is tough as much as the international field".

Of course, nobody can decide which field is better or worse. It's just a matter of perspective, dreams, and values. However, it is true that such drastic changes of field immigration to domestic field for last few years can't be overlooked anymore and we need to think over the phenomenon with careful attention.

Lim Gyung-Bin
Junior Writer, 17th Wave

Statistics given by Mr. Kang Mun-Geun, Head of College Admissions and Counseling for domestic field



College counseling session for domestic field students(left), College counseling session for international field students(right)

We Want YOU to Make a DIFFERENCE

Through what ways
have you raised your opinions about the school?
Have your opinions been heard and
have they brought real changes to the school?
As the last feature project of 2012,
the Minjok Herald Feature Crew has inspected
how the students voice out about school affairs
and how those voices are transmitted
to the school and other students.
This time, many articles made novel attempts:
the three-party discussion with Mr. Han Man-Wi
and the chiefs of the student council
was hosted by the Feature crew,
which represented the student body;
another article compares
how other schools—HAFS and CSIA—
developed their own ways of student expression.
As always, feature crews have exerted themselves
to interview, analyze, survey, and write high-quality articles.
Enjoy!

DIFFERENCE

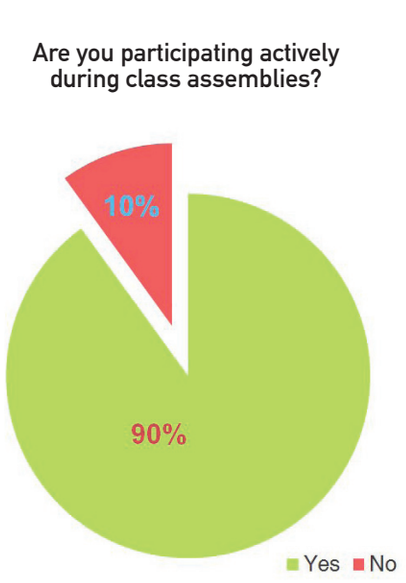
More than 90 percent of the Show but Do Not Put their

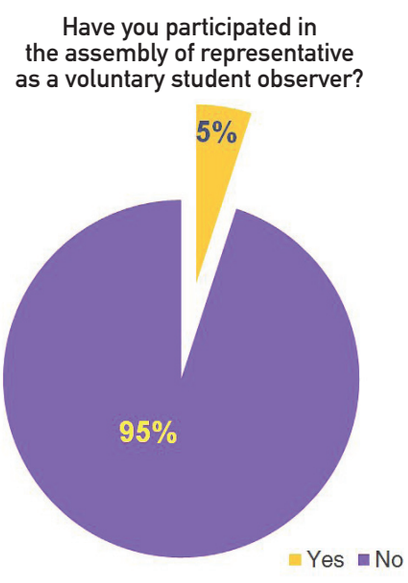
Korean Minjok Leadership Academy (KMLA) had always taken pride in the fact that it is a school where students are given the right to participate in the process of deciding school policies and events. Whereas teachers decide most of the school events and students do not have chances to influence school policies in most high schools, KMLA is special; it provides students with numerous opportunities for students to speak up. Throughout KMLA's short history, students have taken advantage of this point, making sure their voices are heard by other students and teachers.

Recently, the Feature Crew of Minjok Herald conducted a survey to see how many students are actively providing opinions regarding KMLA. The survey consisted of questions about the student council, the KMLA forum, the class assemblies, and Facebook. The results showed that KMLAians are not as eagerly expressing their opinions as many would have expected.

According to the results of the survey, only 21 students out of 129 have participated in providing the questions for the student council interim assessment. This is about 16% of the survey participants, which means that approximately 84% of the students have never sent any questions regarding assessment of the student council. Furthermore, among the KMLAians who participated in the survey, only seven students have participated at the assembly of representatives as voluntary student observer. This amounts to only about 5%, which implies almost all KMLA students are not interested in voluntarily observing the assembly of representatives. 18 students did not even know about voluntary student observers.

The student council interim assessment and the voluntary student observer policy are both systems that exist to encourage student participation in school affairs. Why are students not using them much? It is not because they are apathetic; many students are, in fact, very interested in how the school is working. Out of the 129 students, 108 students visit the Legis-





Students Interest in School Policies Interests into Action

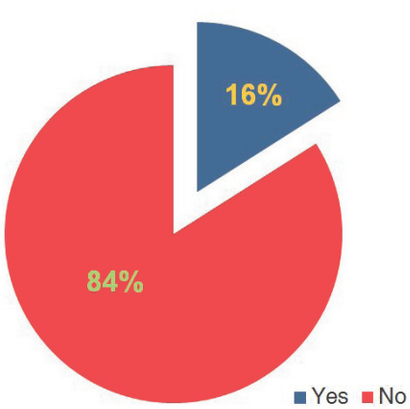
lative Board, Judicial Board, and the Executive Board at least once a week; 33 of them visit the boards almost every day. Moreover, ninety students among the 129 KMLAians replied they are actively participating in class assemblies. It is also interesting to note that students are expressing their opinions about the school on Facebook through their statuses. 64 students, which is about half of the survey participants, have used Facebook as a place to write down what they think about school affairs at least once.

According to the 16th waver Lee Se-Hee, who is the former chief of the Department of Audit and Inspection, there seems to be several reasons behind this phenomenon. "The second semester is short. Students have many assignments, quizzes, and events such as the Minjok Music Festival. In addition, the lack of promotion also contributed to the low student participation rate." Especially in the case of the student council interim assessment, Sehee noted that whereas the Legislative Council helped collect students' questions formerly, this time the department was on its own. "Although the Department of Audit and Inspection is responsible for most of the assessment questions, more student participation would make the interim assessment more objective and trustworthy," she added.

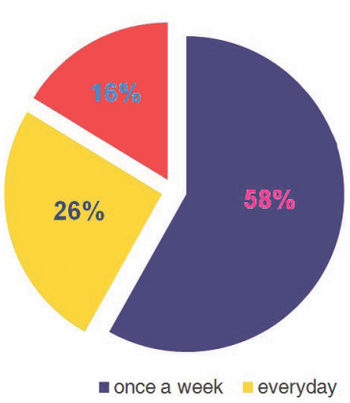
KMLA is not a school led by teachers and personnel only. Students play significant roles in decision making. Their opinions are shaping and will shape the way our school is. We as students should keep that in mind and take advantage of school policies to exercise our rights and have our voices heard.

Chang Jun-Hyuk
Feature Writer, 17th Wave

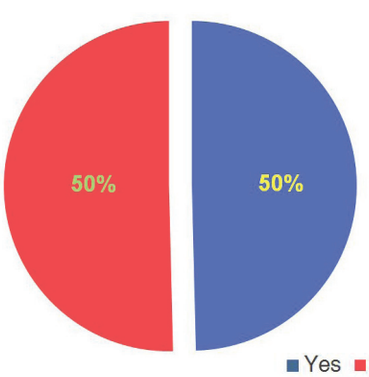
Have you provided question for the student council interim assessment?

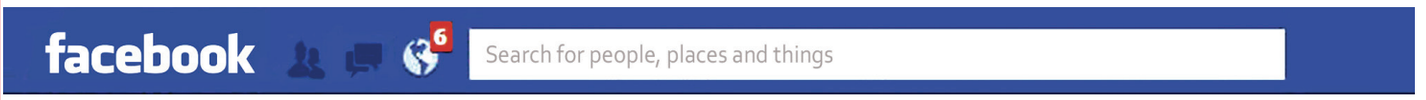


How often do you visit the student council's bulletin board on KMLA Online?



Have you ever expressed your opinions on school policies through facebook?





Drastic Increase in Students Using Facebook as a Channel of Communication

Highly Accessible, but has Limits of Informality

In our school KMLA, communication between students and teachers is crucial. There are no parents, and there is no one else to help make changes for us. The only way to improve the environment that we live in is to actively communicate with the teachers and the school authorities. In order to actualize the desire of students, many solutions have been proposed by the student body throughout the history of KMLA. In fact, KMLA Forum and KMLA Talk were all started to encourage student participation in the KMLA autonomy. However, students tend to express their opinion through Facebook rather than the separate spaces provided for them (KMLA Talk, KMLA Forum). There can be many reasons why students like to express their opinion on their Facebook accounts. Handiness of accessing Facebook, and the comparatively free atmosphere of cyberspace may be the possible reasons. But, it seems like Facebook clearly has its limits. While it is an effective way to express personal opinions, to expect change in reality through Facebook seems a bit far-fetched.

Former president of the Judicial Council, 16th waver Koo Han-Kyeol gave his opinions about the usage of Facebook as a means of communication between students and the school. His opinion on communication through Facebook was that it has its limits. Although Facebook by far is the most popular channel of communication within KMLA, he claimed that it cannot be used as a formal way of appealing to the teachers and the school authorities. If students have things to say about the school policies, he said that it must be properly delivered to the student council, or to KMLA Talk. An even bigger problem that Mr. Koo saw with the opinions on Facebook was that it does not have much logic to it. In order for the teachers to accept the opinions of the students, students must come up with some proper reasoning. Unfortunately, he said that most of the opinions that he sees on Facebook is based on emotion rather than logic. Students trying to participate in the student autonomy are a great phenomenon, regardless of where the effort takes place. However, to expect great deal of change is realistically difficult. At least Mr. Koo believes so, reflecting on his experience as a member of the student council.

The current deputy headmaster of KMLA, Mr. Han Man-Wi also gave a few words about his thoughts on using Facebook to appeal to the school. Mr. Han viewed students' eagerness to change the school into a more favorable one very positively. However, he wished that the way students approach the matters are quite problematic in the perspective of the school. The fact that the students act too emotionally on Facebook is the main problem that he sees. Also, he urged the students to use places such as KMLA Online and KMLA Talk to express their opinions instead of using an informal source like Facebook. He concluded his words with the message that he sent through his speech during the morning assembly; students should try to respect the rules made by school before simply complaining about them. Mr. Han emphasized that no rules in the school are made to simply distress the students. He said that all rules are made with purposes, and he strongly recommended the students to keep the rules and show that we have the right to complain about the rules.

KMLA is often referred to as an 'autonomous republic of students.' It is our pride to run the school by the control of the student body. In order to use this unique specialty of our school to our own benefit, we must give ourselves a careful thought about what Mr. Koo and Mr. Han said. There is no doubt that Facebook is highly accessible and popular. But is it really the best place to seek for change of our school? Shouldn't the students use more formal places such as KMLA Talk? Wouldn't it be better to be more logical than emotional when appealing to the school about unsatisfactory regulations? For a better school and a better life at KMLA, it's time for all of us to give this some serious thought.

Yang Jae-Ho
Feature Writer, 17th Wave

Selective Anonymity Policy on KMLA Forum Increasing Both Participation and Cases of Abuse

Active Regulation Measures may be the key to solution

Starting from the November of 2012, KMLA Online, the student homepage of KMLA (Korean Minjok Leadership Academy) introduced the "Selective Anonymity Policy" limited to the area of the KMLA Forum. The KMLA Forum is an online forum which was made by the 13th Executive Council in order to allow free discussions between students about school matters. However, despite its goodwill, the KMLA Forum was not well activated for several reasons. Among such, the most dominating one was that students feared the possibility of being publically criticized online. Due to such, this new policy was introduced in the hope of higher participation from the students on the forum.

The policy did accomplish its original goal. The number of postings after the new policy was introduced has already far surpassed the number before the policy's introduction. However, there are many unexpected side-effects that are arousing up. Irresponsible posts have increased along with the increase of anonymous posts. Comments and remarks that have no relationship to the discussed matter are increasing and some students are using the anonymity policy to criticize others. Some just post articles that criticize another individual or entity publically without leaving any space for discussion. For instance, a posting related to the EOP policy and the morning assembly was followed with 19 comments. Among the 19 comments, two were anonymous users correcting minor grammatical errors and six were anonymous users making harsh comments upon the writer of the post. Many students find these anonymity abusers very annoying and this sometimes leads into conflicts on the web. One student even confessed that he had posted an article related to the school's administration but had deleted it because of the harsh criticisms by the anonymous users. Because of these problems, many other students find the Forum highly problematic and voice out that the situation demands immediate action.

In response to such uprising problems, the 14th student council and the member of Dotnet, the club responsible for the managing of KMLA Online, have suggested a possible breakthrough. They have set a special rule solely for such anonymity issues on the KMLA Forum. Song Ho-Young, the chief of the 14th judicial council, said in an interview with Minjok Herald that the selective anonymity policy has brought about many unexpected side-effects, thereby disturbing the atmosphere of the KMLA Forum. He mentioned a few examples of such cases of abuse and that "The student council thus felt the need for some kind of action to be taken."

From now on, anonymous users posting irresponsible posts will receive a warning and will be restrained from posting as anonymous users. Also, students who leave anonymous comments that are irrelevant or comments that denounce others will also receive warnings. With more than two warnings, such students will not be able to post or leave comments anonymously. Thus, students who wish to post articles or leave comments anonymously will have to keep these rules in mind. With such regulative measures set, the student council and the dotnet expect the decrease of irresponsible actions on the forum. Other than these, many other possible solutions, such as granting members of the student council the right to access the real name of the anonymous users, are still being discussed.

Suh Dong-In
Feature Writer, 16th Wave

Three Party Meeting

MH Staff, Student Council and Dr. Han Man-Wi

MH Staff	Student Council	Dr. Han
Nowadays, regulation regarding teacher's direction is a hot issue among students.	I believe this issue is very controversial because of the arbitrary usage of the teacher's direction clause. I think the standards for awarding penalty points are very ambiguous while rules regarding award points are clearly stated.	I think the problem is whether it is reasonable enough to give out penalty points for violating teacher's direction when we evaluate a certain action.
	But the standards between the students and teachers are grossly different.	First, I think there are a lot of cases that we are clearly against the rule. For example, if a student repeated the same folly which the dorm parent told him not to do, I think the student deserves to get the penalty points. Second, law about teacher's direction is the only way to impose appropriate penalties on students who deserve heavy punishment.
	What kind of heavy punishment regulations were there in the past?	In the past, students who violated the dress code regulation, for example, received one extra penalty point every time he or she violated the rule once more. Teacher's direction rule substituted that system.
	But some students are accusing the regulation for double jeopardy.	I totally understand what you are talking about. However, students should try to find tangible alternatives to the rule, instead of whining over the unreasonableness of the regulation. We can't get rid of the rule all together anyways. In that way, we can find common ground for negotiation between the school and the students. Also, as far as I know, the judicial council has some power to have a say on this issue. To what extent can the judicial council deal with this matter?
	I guess the current system is okay to some extent because the judicial council have the ultimate power to interpret the student law. Whenever the dorm parent or Mr. Kim orders us to rule the court in a certain direction, we accept such demands only when we think they are reasonable. **What do you think about reforming the current law that imposes multiple penalties for a single action?**	That's up to the judicial council to decide.
Students often have a negative perception that the school is inactive and inflexible. Why do you think this kind of perception has been created in the first place?	In my opinion, the disbelief against the school has been created because whenever we gather opinions and deliver them to the teachers, people placed in high ranking positions often refuse to accept our proposals. I think that created the prejudice that the school will not listen to the demands of students.	I think it's not the problem of what the students' demands are about. It's about how you explain students' public opinions to persuade the teachers. We go through prudent and meticulous decision making process to decide whether to accept the proposals.
	We thought there were no trust between the school and the students because teachers didn't provide an explanation to us about the prudent decision making process you've just talked about.	No that is not the case. You see, persuading someone requires prowess and excellence in communication skills. It's either because there may not be enough information or the topic at hand may not be familiar to the person listening to the demands. That is why it is inevitable for teachers to view students' opinions in a critical manner. However, the greatest problem of students is that they give up right away just because they didn't make it in their first attempt. One thing that the students are not taking into account is that students should avidly continue to drive their opinions forward to bring forth change. If you think your proposal is beneficial and rational, go for it. Of course, it will take a lot of effort and time for the teachers to be persuaded. Please take your time and try your best.

MH Staff	Student Council	Dr. Han
What other problems do you think we have in our student autonomy system?		I think our school lacks vertical tradition. Do we have any unique tradition that differentiates KMLA from other schools? This is why the cheering competition was held. Simple and addictive cheering slogans that even graduates can memorize and cheer together with juniors...Only if this culture could be passed on to the next wavers! If such memorable and hooky slogans exist, I believe our school will be more solidified with stronger bonds to each other. Do you think we can call the cheering for our team in last year's sports events with Korea Science Academy a real cheering? Not really. But anyways, I admit that I lack communication skills myself. Even when I talked about 'a', often times, people understand it as 'b'. But one evident thing is that we are not trying to make the students have a hard time in school nor do we have malicious intent in scheduling out school events. There are values and benefits that we thought certain school events will bring forth to students. The Minjok Music concert was held with the same logic.
	Then, what do you think the students should do to make their proposals get accepted by the teachers?	They should actively ask us questions. They should not just whine or complain about school policies but rather stand up to their feet and do their best to understand why they are involved in certain school activities that they are not complacent with. No single person in the school wants the students to have a hard time. We have good intentions on every school event and students should try to understand them in the first place.
	Also, as we went on with our discussion, I suddenly felt that the speeches delivered during morning assembly are quite vague and superficial. On top of that, topics given by the speech don't bear much relevance to the students' everyday lives or real issues that they put more priority in. **Wouldn't it be a good idea if teachers give a speech about what has been discussed in this talk, for example? Also, I hope small-scaled KMLA talks like this one will be held often in the future. I believe this kind of communication between the students and the teachers should be ingrained as part of a positive culture in KMLA.**	I agree on that point. I'll think about it. But above all, every person in KMLA sincerely wishes students the best. Even teachers like me who always reproaches others, want their students to become better people. However, recalcitrant attitudes of students often exacerbate the situation. Positive attitudes characterized by sincere curiosity about school matters and constructive criticism are indispensable for effective communication between the school and the students. Several months ago, one student asked me why rules should exist. All rules exist for a reason because they are made to address the issue that arises every time it becomes problematic. For example, we didn't divide seats between boys and girls in the self-study room in the 11th floor several years ago. Unfortunately, your seniors crossed the line of freedom that the school designated for them. To address that issue, this regulation has been created and is continued to be enforced.
	The Nubi violation is a hot potato of controversy that has risen above the surface.	Of course, prohibiting students from wearing nubi in morning exercises may appear too harsh. However, keep in mind that it is partially because teachers are disappointed at students' insincere attitudes with their noobies on during morning exercises. Freedom comes with responsibility. If students try their best to abide by their responsibilities, the school will be able to have more faith on students and grant even more autonomy in return.
	Dating and food violations have been the two main topics of controversy. What do you think about these ones?	It's the same for dating and food policies as well. In a situation where contact and interaction between boys and girls are inevitable, what kind of parents will send their kids to KMLA if we don't prohibit dating? In the case of food regulations, the school needs to take care of the overall sanitation and health of the students. Let's assume food poisoning happened yesterday. Then, the school needs to shut down for several weeks or even longer to find out the cause for the food poisoning. How are you going to compensate for the losses? Lastly, I would like to comment that freedom will be restricted when responsibility is not kept. Just keep in mind that rules were made to compensate for your irresponsibility. But I do hope this talk will be the beginning for more effective and sincere communication between the students and the school to come.

Where Do We Stand?

KMLA vs. HAFS vs. CSIA

KMLA Shows High Status in its System of Communication System

Throughout Korean Minjok Leadership Academy(KMLA)'s history, students, usually led by the student councils, have developed many policies and systems. As a result, the school has arrived at the present system, and the students and teachers are constantly working out a way to modify the system into a better one. Minjok Herald observed Hankuk Academy of Foreign Studies(HAFS) and CheongShim International Academy (CSIA) to get a clearer view of KMLA's current system and analyze some new ideas for the school.

HAFS has both similarities and differences in their system compared to KMLA. Students can tell their opinions through their class presidents and vice presidents in class meetings. Then, the representatives (including class presidents and vice presidents) have a meeting every week. In the meeting, the representatives deliver the opinions of their class members and decide a topic that is to be debated about in the class meeting. Later, the topic chosen is discussed within class members and the results are recorded and uploaded. A special characteristic of the HAFS system is that it utilizes "Facebook" very much. The student council has an account named "SC HAFS" and students can write their opinions on the school policy on the account's wall. Also, the student council uploads school festivals and announcements on Facebook. On these posts, students are able to write comments and express their thoughts. HAFS students claim that the Facebook system is well-organized and thus effectively utilized.

A bridge between the student council and the school is a department called "Personality and Creativity Department". Periodically, teachers are assigned in the department to listen to what the students need and want. When the student representatives have important matters to be discussed with the school, they have a meeting with the department and express the students' opinions. If a matter is very serious, it is sometimes discussed with the whole school faculty. Unfortunately, HAFS does not have a system for the students to directly communicate with the school. However, the students say that even though indirect, their opinions are well-delivered.

In CSIA, the system is not developed fully; however, the students do not find it necessary. Since the number of students is small, students feel that they do not need a sophisticated system to deliver their opinions. Every student is able to contact the school president directly. If students have something to say, they contact the school president through face-to-face communication, calls, text messages, chats, and so on. CSIA does not have any class meetings and surveys are usually done online. Unfortunately, the communication between the school and the students is very poor. Students state that there is almost no communication between the school faculty and students. It seems that there is no extreme willingness for the students to talk with the school faculty directly. Mostly, the students take care of school work independently, with the lead of the school president and the student representatives (such as the student department presidents).

In order to compare the three schools (KMLA, HAFS, CSIA) better, a table is given below.

	KMLA	HAFS	CSIA
1	Class meetings, KMLA forum, assembly speeches	Class meetings, Facebook	Contact the school president directly
2	Discussion in representative meeting	Discussion in representative meeting	No class meeting
3	Class meeting, representative meeting, KMLA forum, direct contact	Class meeting, representative meeting, Facebook	Contact the school president directly
4	Meeting between the student council and the student guidance department every week	Meeting between the student council and the department of personality and creativity every week	No communication
5	Assembly speech, no sufficient direct communication method	No direct communication	No communication

(1) how the students propose their opinions to the school
(2) how the resolutions to be discussed in class meetings are determined
(3) the communication between students and the student council
(4) the communication between the student council and the school
(5) the communication between students and the school.

The three schools differ greatly in such systems. A part that KMLA should pay attention to is the utilization of Facebook in the HAFS system. Even though KMLA does have a Facebook student council account, it is not activated fully. Considering the fact that almost every student has a Facebook account and that the students spend a lot of time doing Facebook, the HAFS Facebook system is surely a part that KMLA should think about. On top of that, KMLA seems to have developed a lot of system for the student, student council, and school to communicate. The next step is to make each of the system more perfect and encourage students to participate actively in the communication.

Hwang Ye-Seul
Feature Writer, 16th Wave

REAL Changes Made

Head to Toe, Web to Lab
Changes of us, for us, by us

Feeding the Student Autonomy Reformations in the Hair Regulation, Uniforms, and Labs

KMLAians are hungry - hungry for change. Many students are initiating changes in the school, whether they realize it or not, by expressing different thoughts through various channels that range from voting processes in class conferences to Facebook posts on their walls. Even though some would believe that 'student autonomy' has become a hackneyed, hollow phrase, there have been real changes achieved through fruitful communication between the school and the student body.

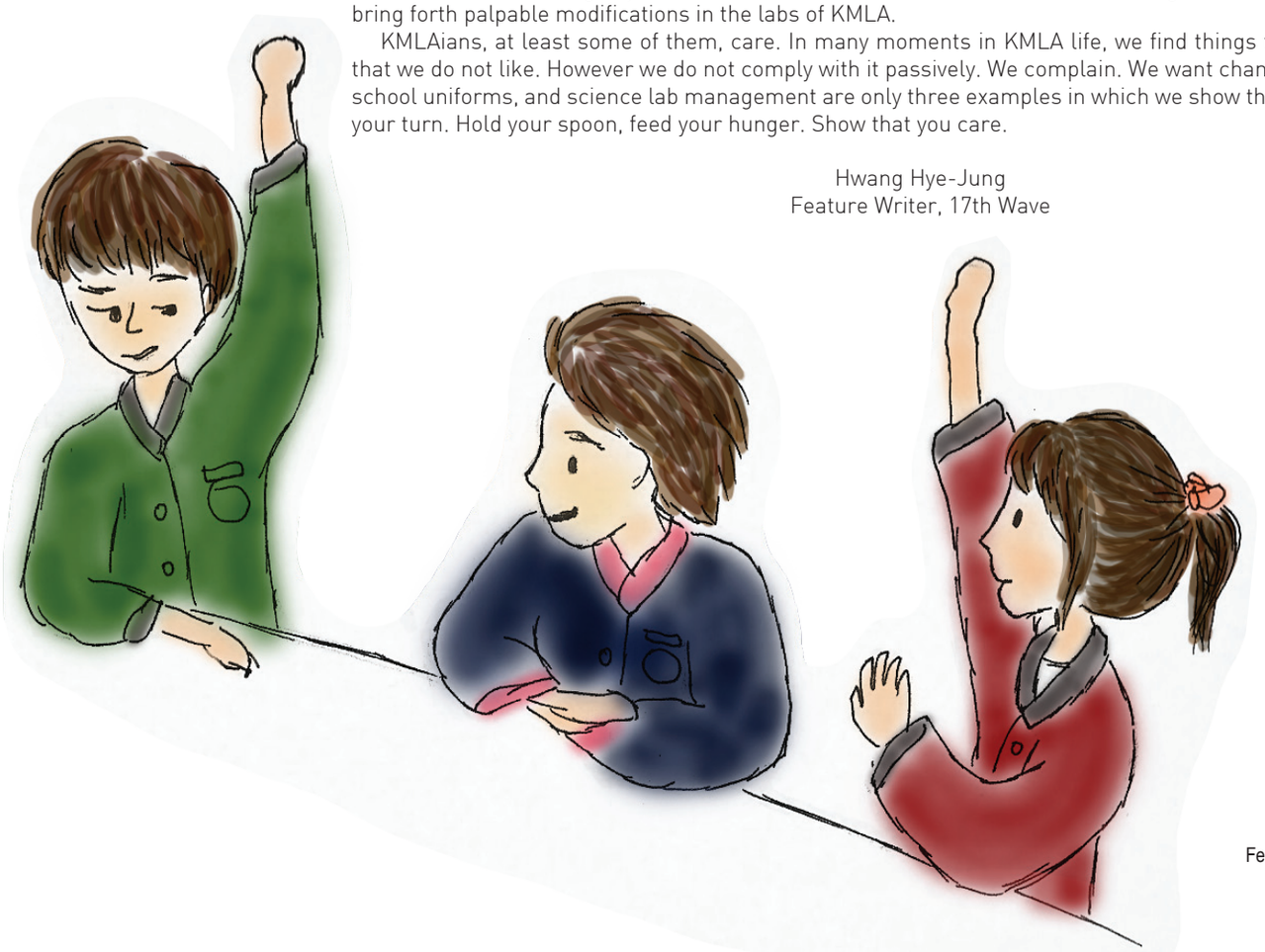
One of the first changes was the hair regulation reformation. Currently, perm or dyeing is prohibited in KMLA. However an item in the October 29th class conference was the hair regulation reformation. Students, since long ago, had had hopes to loosen up the hair regulations. Especially after the Bill of Rights of Students, students murmured about whether if KMLA should be introducing slacker regulations on hair styles. These were unofficial thoughts, but the 14th Legislative Council marshaled these thoughts and visited Director of the Division of Student Affairs, Mr. Kim Myung-Soon. In response, Director of the Division of Student Affairs, Mr. Kim Myung-Soon, made an announcement in the morning assembly that the school would consider allowing moderate levels of dyeing and perm. The item was put to vote in the class conferences, and the 16th and 17th wavers agreed to the change by 74.75%, with a slightly higher percentage of 16th wavers agreeing(79.05%) compared to the 17th wavers(72.97%). Though the specific limits must be set to the new regulation, the policy has passed the student vote. Students are looking forward to express their individuality through the freedom of hair style.

The executive council took the lead for another change. Posts by the executive council on KMLA Online asked for students' participation through comments to pose suggestions for the school uniform company, Ludia Hanbok, to improve the quality of the fabric and design of the school uniform. Many students entered comments on the post, expressing the inconvenience they had felt while wearing the uniforms, from the trivial complaints about the colors of the uniforms to the more serious dissatisfaction about reports of needles falling out of the sleeves of uniforms. The contents of the comments were then passed on to the administration consulting council teachers. After these teachers negotiated with Ludia Hanbok, it promised to make the improvements students wanted.

As covered in Minjok Herald's past feature section, KMLA's science labs are in poor condition. Many times the students had written about fixing the conditions of the labs in the suggestion section of the class conference records, but the school and teachers were not able to help students with this problem. The students, with their sleeves rolled up, decided to change this. A new student club, the science lab management club, was established to manage the conditions of the labs. The club covers all four aspects of science, with five 16th wavers and twelve 17th wavers; each member is full with passion, affection and knowledge in the field of science that interests them. Working in joint with the executive council, the science lab management club is anticipated to bring forth palpable modifications in the labs of KMLA.

KMLAians, at least some of them, care. In many moments in KMLA life, we find things that are given to us that we do not like. However we do not comply with it passively. We complain. We want change. Hair regulation, school uniforms, and science lab management are only three examples in which we show that we care. Now it's your turn. Hold your spoon, feed your hunger. Show that you care.

Hwang Hye-Jung
Feature Writer, 17th Wave



Drawing Done by
Shin Jae-Yoon
Feature Designer, 16th Wave

MERR
Christmas
To-Do List
Grab a cup of hot chocolate
and watch 'Love Actually'
Wrap presents
for your loved ones
Prepare Christmas cookies
and milk for Santa Claus
Make a playlist of
Christmas carols
Enjoy the holiday cheer!

Y
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M
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Saying Good Bye to Our Seniors

Senior Superlatives

15th Waver Suh Hyeong-Ju

Most Likely to Get a Record Deal

15th Waver Lee Jung-Hyun and Kim Hee-June

Sunshine on a Cloudy Day

15th Waver Han Jae-Yeon and Bae Sol-Hee

Inseperable Friends

The Next Beethoven

15th Waver Park Jun-Ho and Park Sun-Woo

Best Body

15th Waver Na Eui-Cheol and Park Ye-Rin

Cutest

15th Waver Ko Jun-Ho and Lee Bo-Ri

Across

2. Chungmoo
4. kippa
5. ten
9. Gwangju
11. IntenSiveRest
12. pink
14. getdown
15. Coffeemaker

Down

1. hang
2. Changeui
3. squirell
6. eunji
7. honjeongbread
8. captain
10. chicken
13. hubaes

Cartoon drawn by
Sung Yoo-Sun,
16th Wave

KMLA BOYZ N GIRLS

Epi.2 Manitto

Creative Writing Corner

The Seagull

My days in Niihau start and end with the sun. The vast nature I see under the sunlight is my only solace here in the lonely island. It has been such a long time since I had any company. I remember my heart going rigid when I had first put a bandage on my kid, I had watched him grow out of six sizes of shoes with amusement, I cherished in tears the day he held his hand with another fully grown woman. However, other than that, I recall not much. My kid flew off to the big land across the Pacific Ocean and a few years later my husband followed to a bigger place somewhere up upon the clouds. When clouds shed rain for quite some time and the bright blue can be seen from the sky, a slight nebulous line can be seen across the horizon of the sea, where I believe my husband came down to watch me from far away.

Yesterday I walked on the shores of the beach near my home. The sand under my soles seemed smoother than usual. Although the tide carried a cold color of grey, the white foams that it carried couldn't look any softer. It was depressing how I now couldn't hear the endless swish swashing of the waves, the sound that used to relieve my feelings of doubt and apprehensiveness. The only thing I hear now is the faint exhaling of my breath. My left ear lost its ability to decipher sound when I was young. From then on, the boisterous seagulls started to catch my degrading ear. I developed a love for such creatures.

As I reached the end of where the sandy boarder ends, I sat down. Looking above the sky the world seemed too vast. However, then lowering my eyes back to the ground, I noticed a bent wing. The delicate crevices from each feather tainted in grey belonged no other than to a seagull. I quickly made my way to where the seagull laid. Apart from its colony of birds on the grey rock, it seemed to be in pain. I immediately carried it home.

I had no idea how to treat the creature, but I attached a cut hardboard paper to the wing for support. The seagull made me smile. Amusingly, I felt a slight link towards the injured bird. How, I do not know; however, the fragile white creature isolated from its kinds reminded very much of myself. I couldn't help smiling. Nothing was more interesting to me that night than to watch the delicate movements of the seagull and watch it be. I don't remember falling asleep that night, but when I opened my eyes, I found the seagull on the window still. Somehow I sensed it wanted to go back to the ocean to its kinds.

Opening the door, the cold saltiness smell of the beach engulfed my nostrils. With the fragile white seagull in my arms, I head to the end of Kauwaha Beach. The sand didn't feel quite as soft and the white foams the waves made only looked artificial. However, the seagull lay safe in my arms and at that moment that was all that mattered. As I reached the end of the beach, I noticed that there weren't any seagulls gathered; the grey rocks were bare and lifeless. I decided to take the seagull myself to where its kinds are, to the sea. I took a step into where the shallow waves made beautiful patterns on the sand. I could feel the coolness reach my toes to my legs. Grasping the seagull to set it free into the water, I noticed that the slight movement of its chest had stopped.

I now stand in the sea. The cold temperature gradually reached my chest. The seagull in my hand isn't moving. I look across the distance. It must have rained early in the morning. I see a blue line across the horizon. I see the dead seagull in my hands. I see the ocean. The blue ocean. The ocean that was there throughout my life. It carried my kid to another place. It swallowed my husband. I stand here with the white seagull. I slowly feel my body relaxing. The water now seems light. I slowly close my eyes. I leave my body to the ocean. The seagull still in my hands.

Kim Nu-Ri
Guest Writer, 16th Wave

Finding Joy in Our Busy Lives

Interview with our Math Teacher Ms. Chun Hyun-Koo

In Korean Minjok Leadership Academy (KMLA), it's not only the students who often put aside books and lay down pens to head to parties and shows. The teachers also wonder the students with entirely new aspects of enjoying hobbies. This was clearly illustrated when the teachers' band in Minjok Music Festival instantly captured the attention of everyone in the auditorium with fascinating music. But what is shown on the stage isn't everything. Some hobbies that don't appeal to others are also meaningful and Jeon Hyun-Koo, our international math teacher, had a special hobby to share with us.

Q: Students say that you have a special and unusual hobby that you do in the weekends. Could you share it with us?
A: Sure. I make potteries in the weekends.

Q: When and why did you start this hobby?
A: It was 2009 when I first learned how to make potteries. I had been learning painting since 2006 in an arts academy. The principal teacher of the academy one day told me that a person she had acquaintance with made potteries. In August, we went to visit him. His potteries and the process impressed me a lot. I instantly decided to learn how to make potteries. At first, he firmly said that he wouldn't teach anyone. But I begged him and he finally allowed me as his only student. From then on, I went there on the weekends and learned for about 10 hours a day. After a year, I found a workroom in Seoul. The people there were professionals who made and sold their potteries. Although I was not a professional, I started making my own potteries among them. And my hobby has continued until now.

Ms. Chun Hyun-Koo making pottery

Q: Pottery is a rare hobby nowadays. What is it that attracts you?
A: Pottery requires tremendous concentration and patience. Although clay is not alive, it certainly is when making pottery. If your concentration falters a little, then it loses its balance and the right shape. Often, the result is very unsatisfactory and I often succeed in making only two or three potteries after working for a whole day. But this is what attracts me. When I am concentrating so hard that I can't listen to any other noise, time flies by. I like the fact that there is even one thing that I can concentrate on.

Q: What does making pottery mean to your life? How did it contribute to your character or personality?
A: Pottery means a lot to me because it provides me with an activity that I can pour my efforts on. When I stop teaching, I will live a peaceful life making potteries. I also have thoughts on studying pottery professionally. Speaking of my personality, I'm not really extroverted. I rather enjoy doing things that I can do quietly on myself. In this sense, pottery perfectly matches my personality.

Q: Do you know of any other KMLA teachers who have unusual hobbies?
A: Ryu Hyun Soo teacher has been sky diving for a long time. You should interview him too.

Q: Many students in KMLA study very hard, so they find very little time for personal hobbies. What do you want to say to them?
A: Students should make at least one thing that they enjoy doing. Those activities should be done out of pure joy, not out of duty. These activities will make their school life more enjoyable and also blow life into other things they do. For me, making pottery not only affects the weekend, but the whole week. It helps me enjoy school life. It doesn't matter whether others appreciate what you enjoy doing, do it for yourself and have fun!

Lee Chang-Hun
Junior Writer, 17th wave

Too Many Penalty Points? Not For Us!

A Talk with Collectors of Award Points, Choi Hong-Bum and Lee Se-Yong

If someone asks any KMLA student about something they hate doing, one of the first things that will come up in his or her mind would be going to court. Every month, at least several dozen students can be seen working on school grounds for special training. The piling of penalty points has been, and will probably continue to be, one of the major concerns of KMLA students. This year especially had a considerable increase in people with high penalty points compared to past years. Statistics from the Department of Justice show 37 students with over 40 points, 6 students with over 60 points, and 3 over 70 points. However, in the midst of these mounting penalty points, some students in KMLA pile award points. 16th waver Choi Hong-Bum and Lee Se-Yong boasts a total of -17 points, the current lowest aggregate total of penalty points.

It wasn't hard to get information from both Choi Hong-Bum and Lee Se-Yong. Both students were eager to answer our interview enthusiastically, showing that they were proud of themselves for being the students with the lowest penalty points.

The first one to interview was Choi Hong-bum. "There are students who have 0 penalty points, you know. If so, I am not the one who should be standing out" he said, having 32 pure award points to block his 15 penalty points. Through the interview with him, it seemed that he spent his 2nd grade really well. "I usually got all of my award points by not going to the court, floor master, and helping outsiders look around the school ground." Being awed by all of the activities he did, and by his high award points, I asked him what is the difference between him and the rest of the students. Humble Choi answered, "I don't think I am the appropriate one to answer this, but if there is a difference, it would be taking all of this seriously instead of letting yourself slick away once or twice."

Answers that Minjok Herald got from Lee Se-young were a little different from Choi Hong-bum. He showed how having low penalty points can be beneficial. Like Choi Hong-bum, his high award points were the result of lots of activities that he did during this year. However, there was a big difference between him and the former interviewee-he has absolutely no penalty points. "Actually, my penalty points were quite high last year," said Lee, when asked about how he ended up with not going to the court for so long. "After ending my 1st grade with some penalty points, I tried to keep two promises that I made with myself-controlling myself, and always keeping my area clean and neat. By doing so, I was able to not go to the court for such a long period of time." AS a relief to those with high penalty points, he say that high records that one currently have does not have anything to do with the points they will get the next semester. "The real important thing is not the penalty points that you have, but how your lifestyle will change in the future. Always remind yourself about how to avoid getting penalty points. You will be able to enjoy your life much more than before."

The fact that there are those who have minus penalty points might sound like a faraway fairy tale to most of the students in KMLA, especially those with high penalty points. However, it seems that it is not as impossible to change one's life just like Choi and Lee did.

Kim Ji-Ho
Junior Writer,
17th Wave

16th wavers Lee Se-Yong and Choi Hong-Bum from left to right

No Private Space

One of Those Things, Living in KMLA

"All human beings have three lives: public, private, and secret." – Gabriel García Márquez, Gabriel García Márquez: A Life

I know it is a cliché, but there we have it. Living in a digitalized age has brought the undeniable demise of privacy. Closed-circuit TVs, online accounts, GPS, credit cards, cell phones and all the rest aspire to undermine your security as a person. The nightly news is inundated with cases of identity theft and abuse. We live in a perilous world indeed.

Ironically, however, our lives in Korean Minjok Leadership Academy (KMLA) are barbed with greater hazards to privacy than the electronic devices in the contemporary society. KMLA is sequestered in the mountains; it is hardly the forerunner in modern technology. Being a dormitory school, however, it is hard to get rid of the feeling that our every actions are being watched wherever we go.

Call it paranoia, or whatever you like. I have gone in search for a good place to talk more than once. Holding a cell phone in one hand, I have wandered everywhere; the hallway, the stairs, the restrooms, the floor above and the floor below—only to find that the place either resounded excruciatingly or were exceedingly crowded. The danger of an unwanted third-party being present always loomed somewhere. We are essentially being deprived of our private lives. Honestly, it is killing me.

I constantly have an earnest wish to be alone. At the end of a bad day, when my quizzes have gone awry, when I have slept during class, when I am wondering about what I am going to do with my life, and when I miss the things that have slipped away, I really want to be away from everyone. I never thought I would wish for solitude so consistently; but people are bound to be more sensitive about the things that they have lost than the things they already have. Nowhere, in this twelve-floor dormitory can you find a place to be completely alone. Venturing outdoors can also be a possibility. Our school is by far the largest high school in Korea. The problem is that we are locked indoors after seven. I have found that to be suffocating more than once.

The major problem with this gradual suffocation is that people tend to release it, often in unpleasant ways. I tend to be more irritable to my friends, because without any private space there is no chance to think the problems through; when that happens, the questions begin to accumulate into an intimidating heap. No one can deal with something like this on a rational level-which bring conflict into the picture. Anxiety, raised voices, extreme irritation, and depression are all symptoms of a wider range of problems dating back to the lack of privacy in our school life.

I tried to rationalize this problem once. The reasoning went like this: dormitory life means a twenty-four-seven exposure to the public. What better way to train the students to become responsible and considerate? While consolidating relationships between friends to become strong like those between family members, the school can also encourage students to watch themselves. Such qualities would be invaluable in living out life in the future society.

The educational aspects of dorm life I can fully understand. Being placed in an extreme environment can be a rewarding experience. In the short term, however, I do need some breathing space. If the school cannot provide me with one, it is up to me to find that nook where I can take comfort in.

Sometimes my life feels like a war zone-a war with school work, with impossible schedules, and with all the different relationships I have to manage. The promise that this struggle will be rewarding sometimes serves as my lifeline. So when you have problems you seem to not be able to make heads or tails of, step back, and give yourself some time to work it out. We need to acknowledge that living this kind of public life is stressful in itself. We can start solving the problem from there.

Park So-Hyeon
Columnist, 17th Wave

The Bliss of Darkness

It is two o'clock in the morning. The dormitory is suddenly plunged into darkness, with the exception of the lights in the bathroom and hallway.. I am suddenly blinded, unable to discern any object. My roommates softly sigh to themselves, reach for their emergency lights, and turn on this only source of light. Until very recently, I was the first one to sigh when the clock struck two, and the first one to grumble about the needless tradition at our school dormitory. The blackout not only meant the total absence of light, but also limited access to the internet. I remember hastily surfing through the internet a few minutes before two o'clock in order to open up as many windows as I could before the use of internet was disabled.. This last-minute search never failed to exasperate me and made me pose the question of whether this blackout was a necessary step in our learning process.

Then, I recalled the thoughts that go through my mind every time the lights are turned off. In the sudden darkness without a single ray of light, I remembered thinking of things I should have done when the light was still available, and realizing the importance of the light that I did have. This total absence of electricity, in essence, had reminded me of what I should have done when it was still provided and how valuable it had been. Thinking back, this meant that without the absence of electricity, not one student in the dormitory would be grateful to the endless supply of electricity.

In this era of "light pollution," the society is filled with so much light that electricity is taken for granted. We are used to turning on lights for every single task, and are nearly crippled without the supply of electricity. Unlike the past, people no longer find the need for alternative light sources such as candles or flashlights and are thus left vulnerable in the hands of electricity. For example, without the help of light, I wouldn't be writing this article, for my laptop would not be charged; you wouldn't be reading this newspaper, for you wouldn't have any candles or flashlights by your side. But, as we all know, this does not happen very often. Electricity is constantly provided-- that is, if we are willing to pay for it. But it is not only electricity that is overly supplied. With economic development taking place worldwide, clothes, food, and education are becoming abundant. However, such heightening in our economic standards of living is coming at the cost of our happiness. Too much education that was originally intended to guide students in the right path is providing more of a stress than guidance; too much food is forcing people to become obese. And just as how we should learn the value that electricity plays in our daily lives, we should remember to not take for granted those that are abundant in our life.

Such abundance makes it easy for people today to forget the true value of their surroundings. Even looking back at ourselves, I realized that many students of KMLA may be forgetting how blessed they are. Forgetting that we are so blessed to be breathing and living at this moment, to be born in a good family that cares about us and loves us, and to be encouraged to pursue our studies to the fullest extent. The two o'clock blackout might seem inefficient and seem like a hurdle in our studies, but it might be a good idea to take a moment of that darkness to look back upon ourselves. At times, it is darkness that enables us to see the most, and it is the thought that we obtain at this time of hour that makes it such a blissful one.

Suh Yeon-Soo
Columnist, 16th Wave

The Hypocrisy of EOP

I like the English Only Policy (EOP). I am an ardent supporter of its propagandizing, advertising, self-serving ways and understand that the school, being the exemplary Korean Minjok Leadership Academy (KMLA), must exploit this policy as much as possible. Though intended for the students, we all know that the EOP doesn't really serve the students as much, and as well, as it serves the school's image and getting our unintelligent selves into naïve American colleges. No, I shouldn't say unintelligent, because unintelligent means that the students do not question or enforce a regulation that they inherently agreed to when they applied to this school. No, KMLA students are not like that.

No sarcasm, not completely at least. It is true that the majority of KMLA students do wish to keep EOP, at least the EOP they thought of when they first entered the school: the EOP that works for the students, is kept by all the students, and, equally importantly, is kept by all the teachers. Meanwhile, in the current status quo, it seems that there are many issues that need to be resolved.

Currently, any class not taught by the English Department is taught in Korean, the AP courses included. Practically, it may be more reasonable for the majority of the teachers to teach in Korean since they are more comfortable in Korean. Even though most of the teachers are fluent in English at least in reading and writing, their lecturing skills are supposedly better in Korean. This increased ability would, of course, increase class participation. However, the problem lies with the fact that even when classes are taught in Korean, these extra benefits do not occur. Discussions are as stagnant in those classes taught in Korean as they supposedly would be if these same classes were taught in English, if not worse. In the majority of AP classes, teachers lecture to a sleeping classroom and often the students do not actually study the subject until it is time for Midterms, Finals, or the AP's. Therefore, this current situation begs the question: should the EOP be compromised for such "practicality?"

Furthermore, classes with English content should be taught in English for the same reason that the school conducts Korean classes in Korean. Just as it is better for Korean History or Korean Culture class to be taught in Korean, it is more beneficial for the students for classes such as AP US History and AP US Government to be taught in English. Perhaps these classes should be taught in Korean for better class participation, but we see that this participation does not exist even when these classes are taught in Korean. Furthermore, the school should realize that the purpose of EOP is not just to allow KMLA students to become conversationally fluent in English but to be able to discuss academic subjects in English in a coherent way as well. In this aspect of introducing students to academic English discussions, it is indubitable that adherence to the English Only Policy in all classes would be beneficial.

Additionally, this lack of enforcement of the EOP by the faculty is more consequential than they would expect. First and foremost, it is hypocritical to threaten students to keep the EOP through the use of penalty points and peer spies in the form of "EOP Helpers" while the faculty does not adhere to the policy they so desperately preach. It is true that the EOP is for the students, and therefore it is of utmost importance for the students to keep this policy in the first place. However, the teachers should realize that they contribute more to the English atmosphere more than they realize. A 16th wave student, who wishes to remain anonymous, mentioned in a discussion on EOP during Mr. Tweedie's English Composition class: "It is awkward to try to keep EOP with your friends in the hallways than have to change to Korean in the classroom." Perhaps in KMLA instead of "Practice what you preach" it is "You practice what we preach."

Therefore, the practical benefits of conducting classes in Korean do not exist while the harms are prevalent. In general, however, it is unfortunate that such an article as this should exist since classes are supposed to be conducted in English anyways, at least based on the founding principles of this school.

Chung Yoo-Jin
Columnist, 16th Wave

The Nubi Prohibition a.k.a The Failure of Communication

A Need for an Effective Way to Express and Understand One Another

It was like any other morning assembly, that is, until the headmaster went up the podium to make his morning speech. The speech itself presented enough controversy to wake up the drowsing students. As far as the students understood, in order to get "real" exercise, the headmaster had told the onlooking students not to wear any overcoats while morning exercise. However, later on, it turned out that wearing the school uniform jacket, called nubi in Korean, to morning exercise was against school regulations. Students who wore their nubi to morning exercise were accused by the dormitory parent for violating the dress code.

The reason behind the school's sudden and quite awkward regulation is that it was originally illegal to wear casual clothes with the school uniform; thus, alluding to the fact that wearing nubi over normal clothing was against school regulations. Such decision may have been based on logical grounds, but it was definitely unwise.

What students wear the most in Korean Minjok Leadership Academy (KMLA) is the school uniform; not only because it is mandated by the school regulations, but because it is comfortable, especially the nubi. Most students wear their nubi when they take a short trip up to the cafeteria, go out to morning exercise, take a short walk outside, or even when they go home. Nubi, to students, is not actually considered as a part of the school uniform, but rather a comfortable jacket they can wear when it is cold. The school's decision to regulate the wearing of nubi was unwise because it was a policy ignorant of what the nubi actually meant to the students. In addition, the policy itself was quite an inflexible one, considering that the situation the policy created forced many students that lived far away from home to prepare an extra coat in replacement of one of the warmest coats students wore. In such cold weather in the secluded mountains of KMLA, it is a fact that our nubi is more than a uniform; rather it is a part of students' daily lives.

What worsened the problem caused by the school ignorance towards the students and lack of attempts to understand their sides was the failure of communication between the students and the school. The morning assembly speech, one of the rare chances to speak to all the students and teachers of the school, attracts even the attention from drowsing students. Usually, the content of the morning assembly speech remains a controversial issue for a few days, if short, and a few weeks, if long. The content of the speech, and its delivery are important matters that influences the students' and the teachers' understanding of the school. But, what about the headmaster's speech in regards to wearing nubi to morning exercise? With all due respect, it ended up as a failure in communication; his intentions of delivering the speech did not reach the students. Nobody was able to understand the intentions or message of his new "policy." When the dormitory supervisor started to accuse students with "Dress Code Violation," the students understood this new policy as one of the many "impossible-to-understand" courses of action the school had taken. Until a comparatively more reasonable explanation offered by Mr. Kim Myung-Soon through the student council, this new policy was under severe criticism. As a result, the lack of an appropriate explanation worsened the students feeling of disagreement with the new policy.

Another point to consider is that students were not that surprised to hear such incomprehensible policy. This infers how students are used to the school forcing such policies. More than the fact that the school does not allow nubi to be worn, it is the inflexibility of many of the school's policy that is the important problem at hand. In our "KMLA family," it is crucial that each "family member" voluntarily participates in new regulations—students included. However, the lack of clear explanation from the upper echelon of the family and their reliance on penalty points as a measure to implement their policy are a clear discouragement and obstructs our family from functioning properly. It's time that the school persuades its students, instead of mercilessly giving out penalty points to enforce their policy upon confused and quite frustrated students. One way that should be made to good use is the morning assembly speeches, which is now no more than a source of confusion among the students.

Students trudging to morning exercise with their own personal outers rather than school noobies

The Buck Stops Here

Taking Responsibility for One's Own Action

To "pass the buck" is to attribute another person or group with responsibility for one's actions. This strategy is used in power politics – blaming actions of one country on another, providing a perfect opportunity for conflict.

Though far from bringing about international conflict, power politics brought on by buck-passing exists here in Korean Minjok Leadership Academy (KMLA) as well —the concerned parties most obviously being the teachers and students. Naturally, teachers are at a position of authority; as such, students like to blame teachers for certain policies that are regarded unfair and ineffective. Mounting complaints eventually lead to a breaking point, and both parties suffer from full-on frustration, misunderstandings, and disappointments. In the end, disappointed teachers end up imposing more restrictions upon students — further deepening the conflict. In order to prevent such a cycle of mistrust from prevailing, we first need to examine the root of the cause behind the so-called, 'unfair and ineffective policies.'

A closer examination reveals that most policies with poor reputation are often a result of student misbehavior, rather than teacher tyranny. The irresponsible actions of a small number of students bring a painful increase of restrictions for the entire student body. Tighter regulations are initiated, and the weight of the burden is relegated to the student body. As a result, in regulating the small number of irresponsible students, the tightened restrictions are subject to complaints of unfairness and ineffectiveness.

One such example is the sign-up sheet to use the cafeteria during the second self-study period. Before the policy was put into effect, students were able to use the dormitory cafeteria with relative freedom. Given that we did not break existing rules or make excessive amounts of noise, we were allowed to use the cafeteria for various purposes without having to earn approval beforehand. Many students would come up to the cafeteria to study, while others would work on group projects, hold MPT sessions, have counseling sessions with other schoolmates, or just shake off sleep. However, a steady increase in the number of dating couples meeting in the cafeteria put a stop to such flexibility. Students who wish to use the cafeteria during the second self-study session must write their names on a sign-up sheet in the Dorm-parent's office and specify their reason. Now, when the dormitory parent makes rounds to monitor the cafeteria, students whose names are not written on the sheet are given penalty points under the accusation of 'Did Not Follow Teacher's Directions' and sent back to their rooms.

One other primary example that can be given from recent changes is the sign-out sheet in the first floor of the dormitory. The new H+IR module that was introduced at the start of the semester made it possible for certain students to have a free period during afternoon classes. The current school regulations require students to stay outside the dormitory building during school hours. However, this recent increase of freedom for certain students has allowed room for abuse. At the start of the semester, the dormitory parent found several students during the afternoon remaining in their rooms-- a clear violation of school regulations. The increasing amount of students who would abuse this new found freedom had lead to a new policy: students with no afternoon classes are required to sign a paper posted on the first floor before leaving the dormitory to prove that they are not within dormitory premises. Students who do not sign the sheet are sent to court, again, under the accusation of 'Did Not Follow Teacher's Directions.' After the policy was implemented, many students received penalty points that could have been avoided; some could not find the sign-out sheet, others had left the dorm before the sheet was put up, a few others had not even arrived to the dormitory for lunch, and there were those who simply just forgot. Many complain that the rule is impractical and ineffective, and indeed, it may be logical to argue that the rule is irrational for the most part. Nonetheless, the dormitory supervisor had a legitimate reason to implement this policy, and unfair as it may be, the student body as a collective group cannot argue against its legitimacy.

Setting aside these more recent cases, our KMLA history provides countless examples of "passing the buck" to the innocent majority. Whether it be when the dormitory was not locked promptly at seven or when students would leave on weekends without notifying their parents, each time a small number of students start to abuse their freedom, the larger majority was robbed of theirs. The concept of student autonomy is certainly laudable, but action is more important than words. Instead of passing the buck to other students, we need to start taking responsibility; only then can we legitimately claim more freedom. The buck stops here.